

BENZYL ALCOHOL

_____ Name

_____ Date

also called... **phenylcarbinol, phenylmethanol, phenylmethyl alcohol, benzene methanol, benzylic alcohol, and alpha-hydroxytoluene.** It is a component of Balsam of Peru and is naturally present in essential oils of jasmine, hyacinth, and ylang ylang.

What is it?

Benzyl alcohol is a naturally occurring liquid that smells mildly sweet. It has slight numbing and antibacterial effects. Despite its scent, *it may be added to "fragrance-free" products* for its purpose as a solvent, anesthetic, flavoring, or preservative!

Where might it be found?

cologne, aftershave, perfume
shaving cream
deodorant
moisturizer (e.g. Moisturel,
DML, Aveeno, Cetaphil)
anti-aging treatment
cosmetics, lip balm, mascara
facial cleanser (e.g. Aquanil)
make-up remover pads
wet wipes, diaper wipes
shampoos (e.g. DHS)
hair conditioner, style gel
hair color, dye
sunscreens (e.g. Solbar Zinc)
sunless tanner
insect repellent
aloe vera gel
anti-itch preparation (e.g. Itch-
X, Eucerin Itch-Relief, Sarna
Sensitive Lotion)
over-the-counter cortisones
antifungals (e.g. Clotrimazole,
Lamisil Cream)

NOTE: **Benzyl alcohol** may be the **preservative** in eye solutions and injectable medicines, like allergy shots, Botox, gallium, heparin, hormones, local anesthetics, saline solution, steroids (like dexamethasone and methylprednisolone), tranquilizers (such as haloperidol), vitamin B₁₂, and some vaccines.

Tell your doctor about this allergy. Show the lists to the left and below. Certain forms of the following prescription medicines contain benzyl alcohol:

Amcinonide	Imiquimod
Benzoyl peroxide	Metronidazole
Betamethasone dipropionate	Mupirocin
Ciclopirox	Naftidine
Clotrimazole	Ophthalmics
Diclofenac sodium	Pimecrolimus
Doxepin	Sodium sulfacetamide
Fluorouracil	Tazarotene
Flurandrenolide	Tretinoin
Hydroquinone	Triamcinolone

POSSIBLE INDUSTRIAL EXPOSURES:

Adhesives
Cellulose acetate and ester solvent
Cleaning agents
Cosmetics manufacture
Cutting oils
Dye solvent
Ear mold impressions
Flavor industry
Flooring materials
Inks
Microscopy embedding
Perfumery
Pharmaceutical bacteriostat
Photographic developer
Plastics, sheet plastics
Polyethylene film heat seal
Solvent for casein, gelatin
Solvent for shellac, wax
Textiles

(continued)

How to avoid it:

Read the complete ingredient list on the label of every product you use, looking for **benzyl alcohol** or one of its other names above. If no ingredient list is present, go to the store and inspect the original box or package.

Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's website, the store's website, or at websites like

<http://householdproducts.nlm.nih.gov>,
<http://www.cosmeticsdatabase.com>, or
<http://www.drugstore.com>.

For possible workplace exposure, check each product encountered by reading the list of all its ingredients. Your safety officer may help identify products that contain this allergen.

Food sources:

Your doctor may advise you to eliminate sources of ingested benzyl alcohol for a one month trial. If your skin improves, you may try adding back one item per week, watching for worsening.

Benzyl alcohol is found in the following foods:

apricots	French wines
cocoa	honey
cranberries	mushrooms
flavored beverages	snap peas

Persons allergic to benzyl alcohol may show **cross-sensitization** to **tincture of benzoin**, **balsam of Peru**, and **benzylparaben**. Your dermatologist can advise you how to avoid these if necessary.